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'SECRET AFFAIR' THAT COST HEAD OF NAVY HIS JOB

Admiral is first chief to face misconduct probe in 500 years

By Neil Sears and Mark Nicol

THE head of the Royal Navy has been suspended over claims of an affair with a female officer.

Admiral Sir Ben Key was told to stand down from all duties while an investigation is carried out.

The married father-of-three, 59, stepped back 'for private reasons', the Navy said earlier this week. But last night it emerged that, for the first time in the service's 500-year history, its First Sea Lord is facing a misconduct inquiry.

A leak revealed that Admiral Sir Ben had been barred from resigning as the probe into his relationship with a younger woman, said to be a senior officer, continues.

He stands accused of breaching strict regulations barring sexual relations between commanders and those below them in rank. There is no suggestion of anything criminal and the relationship was said to be consensual.

Admiral Sir Ben had previously said he would be stepping down in the summer, but



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